

Meanings of "for" in English Grammar

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Contents

1 1. Purpose or Intended Recipient

- A gift for you
- A tool for cutting wood
- A course for beginners

2 2. Duration

- Waited for hours
- Lived here for ten years

3 3. Support or Favor

- I'm for the new policy
- Are you for or against it?

4 4. Exchange or Cost

- Bought it for \$10
- Traded his watch for a book

5 5. Benefit or Advantage

- Good for your health
- I'll carry that for you

6 6. Reason or Cause

- Praised for honesty
- Thank you for helping me

7 7. Destination or Aim

- Heading for the mountains
- Reached for the book

8 8. Suitability or Appropriateness

- Not suitable for children
- Perfect for summer weather

9 9. Substitution or Representation

- Spoke for the whole team
- Stood in for the manager

10 10. Comparison or Standard

- Tall for his age
- Expensive for a paperback

11 11. Idiomatic Expressions

Expression	Meaning
for good	Permanently
for now	Temporarily
for sure	Definitely
for the sake of	In the interest of
for all I know	As far as I know
for crying out loud	Frustration
for better or worse	Regardless of outcome

12 12. Literary or Archaic Use (Conjunction-like)

- He stayed home, for he was ill
- We must hurry, for the sun is setting

13 Summary Table

Function	Example	Meaning
Purpose/Recipient	A gift for you	Intended for someone
Duration	Waited for hours	Length of time
Support/Favor	I'm for the idea	In favor of
Exchange/Cost	Paid for lunch	In exchange
Benefit/Advantage	Good for health	Beneficial to
Reason/Cause	Applauded for bravery	Because of
Destination/Aim	Left for Paris	Heading toward
Suitability	Not for children	Appropriate to
Substitution	Spoke for the team	On behalf of
Comparison/Standard	Tall for his age	Relative to norm
Idiomatic Use	for good	Permanently
Literary Conjunction	He left, for it was late	Because